

LOGO GOES HERE

# Work Experience Guide

Everything nobody sits you down and explains.  
Twelve pages. Read it on the train.



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Name .....

Dates here .....

My host .....

My desk / floor .....

Written by people who were sitting where you are, not that long ago.

# What's in this guide

You are here for a few days or a few weeks. That is not long. This exists so you do not spend the first three of them working out what everyone does.

- 1 **What this is** — and the five rules that matter
- 2 **Who we actually are** — the Group, and the four bits of it
- 3 **What asset management is** — explained as a shop
- 4 **How the business works** — how someone becomes a client
- 5 **How an investment happens** — from an idea to a trade
- 6 **Who does what** — every team, in one line each
- 7 **Coffee chats** — what they are actually for
- 8 **Questions to ask** — so you never sit there blank
- 9 **Things we wish we'd known** — the honest list
- 10 **Useful links** — and what to watch
- 11 **Your notes** — who you met and what to do next

## THE FIVE RULES

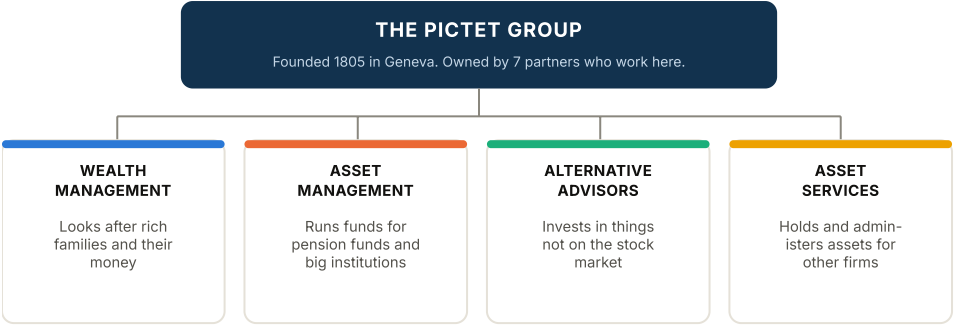
1. **Bring a notebook.** A real one. You will not remember six names by Thursday.
2. **Sleep.** Genuinely. The days are long and you are on show.
3. **Say yes to every coffee.** Especially the boring-sounding ones.
4. **Ask the obvious question.** Nobody expects you to know anything - only to be curious.
5. **Write down names.** Name, team, one thing they said. Page 11 is for exactly this.

## WHAT A GOOD WEEK LOOKS LIKE

You leave knowing what the different jobs are and which of them sound like you. Everything else is a bonus - nobody understood it all in week one.

# Who we actually are

Most people spend their whole placement not quite sure what the company is. Two minutes now saves you that.



**You are almost certainly sitting in ONE of these four.**  
Find out which one on day one - it is the single most useful thing to know.

I am in: .....

My team is called: .....

**THE BIT THAT CONFUSES EVERYONE**

**Pictet Group** is the whole company. Inside it are four separate businesses that do genuinely different jobs for different customers. When someone says 'we', ask which one they mean. It is not a silly question - people who have worked here for years get it wrong.

**WORTH KNOWING**

The firm is 220 years old and has no shareholders and no stock market listing. It is owned by seven partners who all work in the building. That is unusual in finance, and it is the reason people here talk about decades rather than quarters.

# What asset management is

Forget the jargon. It is a shop.

## WHO WE SELL TO

the customers

Pension funds  
Insurance companies  
Sovereign wealth funds  
Wealthy families  
Other banks who sell  
our funds on

## WHAT WE SELL

the product

Not a thing you can  
hold. We sell a  
DECISION: what to buy,  
what to sell, when.  
Wrapped in a fund or  
a mandate.

## HOW WE GET PAID

the till

A small % of the money  
we look after, every  
year.

0.5% of GBP 1bn is  
GBP 5m a year.

## THE WHOLE INDUSTRY IN ONE SENTENCE

We look after other people's money and get paid a small slice of it each year.  
The money is never ours. The decisions are.

## SO WHAT IS A 'FUND'?

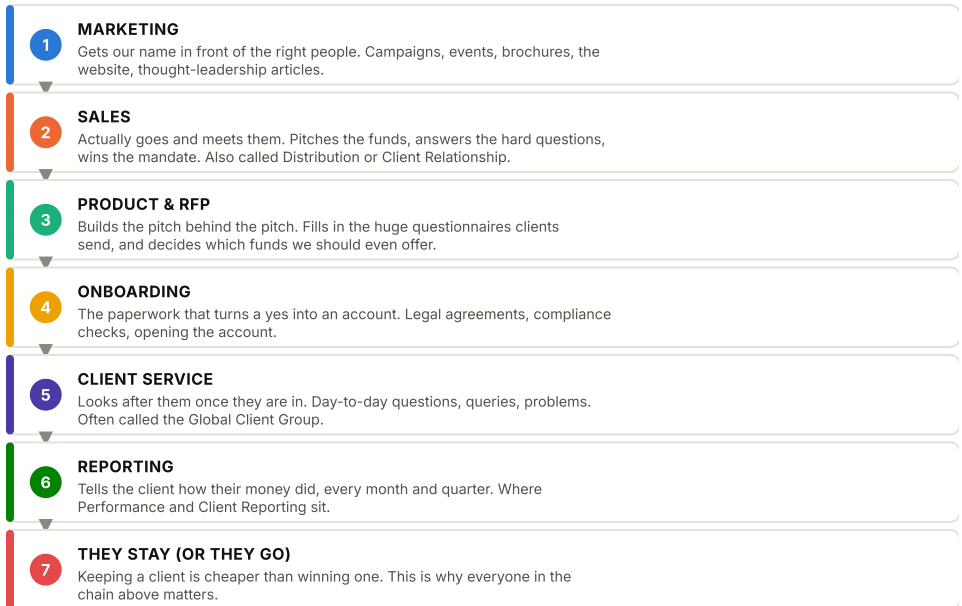
A big pot that lots of different customers put money into, run as one portfolio by one team. Easier and cheaper than running a separate pot for everyone. A **mandate** is the opposite - one giant customer, their own pot, their own rules.

## THE TWO WORDS YOU WILL HEAR CONSTANTLY

- **AUM** - assets under management. How much money we look after. Everything in this building is ultimately about making that number go up and keeping it there.
- **bps** - said 'bips'. One bp is 0.01%. It is how fees get quoted, because the amounts of money involved are enormous.

# How the business works

How a stranger turns into a client, and who touches them on the way. Almost every non-investment job in this building sits somewhere on this chain.



## WHY THIS CHAIN MATTERS TO YOU

Most of the jobs in this building are on this page rather than the next one. If someone says they work in RFP, onboarding or client service, you now know exactly where they sit and who they hand work to.

# How an investment actually happens

Someone has an idea. Days later it is a real holding in a real portfolio. This is what happens in between.

## RESEARCH & ANALYSTS

Study companies, countries and economies all day. Produce the view: is this a good thing to own?

## PORTFOLIO MANAGER (PM)

Makes the call. Decides what goes in the fund, how much of it, and when to sell. Carries the performance.

## TRADER / DEALING DESK

Takes the PM's instruction and works out HOW to buy it without moving the price or paying over the odds.

## EXECUTION

The order actually hits the market, usually through a broker or an electronic platform.

## OPERATIONS / SETTLEMENT

Makes sure the money goes one way and the shares go the other, on the right day, to the right place.

## TRADE SUPPORT

Fixes it when that breaks. Chases the mismatches, the failed settlements, the wrong prices.

## REPORTING & CUSTODY

The asset is recorded, valued daily, and shows up in what the client sees.

## WATCHING OVER ALL OF IT, ALL THE TIME

Risk - Compliance - Legal - Finance - Technology - Investment Data  
No trade happens without them. They are not 'support' in the boring sense.

## THE QUESTION THIS PAGE IS REALLY ASKING

Which of those boxes sounded interesting? Fast and loud (trading)? Judgement and research (PM, analyst)? Making complicated things run properly (operations, trade support)? People and persuasion (sales, client service)? There is no wrong answer, and knowing which one you lean towards is worth more than knowing all the jargon.

# Who does what

One line each. Nobody expects you to memorise this - use it to work out who you want to go and talk to.

## THE INVESTMENT SIDE

| TEAM                          | WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DO                                                                   | FLOOR |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Portfolio Management          | Decide what the funds buy and sell. Carry the performance. Often just called 'the PMs'. |       |
| Research / Analysts           | Study companies, sectors and economies and feed the PMs a view.                         |       |
| Trading / Dealing             | Turn a PM's decision into a real trade at the best price they can get.                  |       |
| Sales / Distribution          | Go out and win the clients. Also called Client Relationship or Business Development.    |       |
| Product / Product Specialists | Know one strategy inside out and explain it to clients. Decide what we should launch.   |       |
| RFP & Proposals               | Answer the enormous questionnaires clients send before they will give us money.         |       |
| Marketing & Communications    | Campaigns, brand, events, the website, and getting our views published.                 |       |
| Client Service                | Look after clients day to day once they are in. Often the Global Client Group.          |       |

### FILL IN THE FLOORS YOURSELF

Teams move around, so the right-hand column is deliberately blank. Ask someone on your first day and pencil them in - it is a genuinely good excuse to start a conversation.

EVERYTHING AROUND IT

| TEAM                        | WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DO                                                             | FLOOR |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Operations                  | Make sure trades settle - money one way, assets the other, on the right day.      |       |
| Trade Support               | Fix it when that breaks. Chase failed settlements and mismatched instructions.    |       |
| Performance & Reporting     | Work out exactly how each portfolio did and tell the client.                      |       |
| Investment Data             | Keep the underlying numbers clean. Everything above depends on this.              |       |
| Risk                        | Check portfolios are not taking risks they were not asked to take.                |       |
| Compliance                  | Make sure everything we do follows the rules of every country we do it in.        |       |
| Legal                       | Draft and review the contracts and agreements behind every client and every fund. |       |
| Finance                     | The firm's own money. Budgets, costs, results.                                    |       |
| Technology                  | The systems, platforms and data everyone else uses all day.                       |       |
| HR / People                 | Hiring, training, and the reason you are here.                                    |       |
| Facilities & Front of House | The building, the desks, the people who make it run.                              |       |
|                             |                                                                                   |       |
|                             |                                                                                   |       |
|                             |                                                                                   |       |

A WORD ON JOB TITLES

Analyst, Associate, Vice President, Director, Managing Director, Partner - roughly in that order. Do not be intimidated by a long one. Ask what someone does, not what they are called.

THE THING PEOPLE GET WRONG

These are not the 'boring' teams. A trade that does not settle is a real problem for a real client, and the people who fix it are some of the busiest in the building. Plenty of people in the front office started somewhere on this page.



# Coffee chats

You will be booked into a lot of these. Most people turn up with no idea what they are for, have a nice enough chat, and get nothing out of it. Here is the actual point.

## THE GOAL, WHICH NOBODY TELLS YOU

Every coffee chat is for **one of two things**. Decide which before you sit down.

- **Learn about their job.** What do they actually do all day, and would you want to do it?
- **Learn about the industry.** How does this bit connect to everything else, and what is changing?

It is *not* an interview and nobody is scoring you. The only bad outcome is walking out knowing nothing new.

## HOW TO RUN 15 MINUTES

- **0-2 min · You.** Two sentences: who you are and what you are trying to work out. Then stop talking.
- **2-10 min · Them.** Get them describing their actual day. People enjoy that far more than strategy questions.
- **10-13 min · Your questions.** Have four ready. You will use two.
- **13-15 min · Close.** Thank them, and ask the one question on the next page that always works.

## BEFORE AND AFTER

- **Before:** two minutes finding out what their team does puts you ahead of most people.
- **After:** three lines in your notebook while it is fresh, and a short thank-you the same day.

## DO NOT

- Ask something the intranet would have answered in 90 seconds.
- Ask how much they earn. People do. Do not be one of them.
- Spend the whole time talking about yourself.
- Sit in silence because you did not prepare - that is what page 8 is for.

# Questions to ask

Cut this page out if you want. Pick four before every chat.

## ABOUT THEIR ACTUAL JOB

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- What did you actually do yesterday?
- What is the part of the job people outside the firm would never guess?
- What is the hardest part - and what is the boring part?
- Who do you deal with most in a normal week?
- What does a good day look like versus a bad one?

## ABOUT HOW THEY GOT HERE

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- What did you study, and does it matter as much as people think?
- Was this the plan, or did you end up here?
- What would you tell yourself at my age?
- Did you move teams to get here? Is that normal?

## ABOUT THE INDUSTRY

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- What has changed most in the time you have been doing this?
- What is everyone in your team talking about at the moment?
- Which other team do you rely on most, and why?
- If I wanted to understand your world, what should I read or watch?

## ABOUT THE FIRM

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- How is this place different from where you worked before?
- What surprised you when you joined?
- What does being partner-owned actually change day to day?

## THE THREE THAT ALWAYS WORK

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- What should I be asking that I have not?
- Is there anyone else you think I should talk to while I am here?
- What would make this week genuinely useful for me?

### IF YOUR MIND GOES BLANK

Use this one: **"Talk me through what you did yesterday."** It works on absolutely everyone, in every team, at every level, and it always leads somewhere.

# Things we wish we'd known

The honest list.

- **Nobody expects you to know anything.** Genuinely. The people who look impressive are the ones asking questions, not the ones nodding along.
- **Everyone is busy, and almost everyone will still make time.** People like talking about their job. Ask.
- **The 'boring' teams are often the most interesting.** Some of the best conversations happen in operations and risk.
- **You will not understand half of what you hear in week one.** Write the words down and look them up later. That is the job.
- **Say yes to lunch.** More gets explained over lunch than in any meeting.
- **Nobody will chase you.** If you sit quietly at a desk for a week, that is what the week will be. Go and ask for things to do.
- **Turn up early, not on time.** Ten minutes is enough and it gets noticed.
- **Names matter more than facts.** Remembering someone's name on day four is worth more than knowing what a basis point is.
- **You are allowed to say 'I don't know'.** Followed by '— how does that work?'
- **Keep in touch afterwards.** A short message in six months beats an urgent one in two years.

## THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST

The point of this is not to impress anyone. It is to find out whether you want to do this for a living, and if so, which bit. Spend the week answering that and it will have been a good week - even if the answer turns out to be no.

# Useful links

Half of this page is blank on purpose - your host will fill in the internal ones on day one.

## INTERNAL — ASK YOUR HOST

- People directory .....
- Intranet home .....
- Strategy / fund videos .....
- Our funds page .....
- Learning platform .....
- Who to email if stuck .....

## WORTH WATCHING OR READING

Search these. Twenty minutes each and the rest of the week makes more sense.

- “What does an asset manager do” — the basics, in plain English
- “What is a fund / what is an ETF” — what we actually sell
- “What does a portfolio manager do all day”
- “Front office vs middle office vs back office”
- “Trade lifecycle explained” — page 5 in more detail
- Investopedia** — look up any word you did not know

## VIDEOS WE'D ACTUALLY RECOMMEND

- .....
- .....
- .....

# Your notes

Fill this in as you go, not on the last afternoon.

| NAME | TEAM | WHAT THEY DO | FOLLOW UP? |
|------|------|--------------|------------|
|      |      |              |            |
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|      |      |              |            |

## BEFORE YOU LEAVE

- ☐ Thanked everyone who gave you time
- ☐ Connected with the people you actually clicked with
- ☐ Written down the three jobs that interested you most
- ☐ Asked your host what a good next step would look like
- ☐ Given honest feedback on the week — it genuinely gets used

## LAST THING

You now know more about how this industry works than most people your age, and quite a few adults. Use it. Good luck.